

The Islamic Institution for Education and Teaching
Al-Mahdi Schools
Class: Third Secondary (GS/LS)
Name: _____

Subject: English Language
First Common Exam
Total Timing: 120 minutes
Date: January ---, 2026

Answer Key of First Common Exam Grade 11-2026

Notes about students' answers

- If stds copied most of the ideas required as they are or listing phrases copied from the text → **deduct (0.25)**
- If stds copied all/most of the paragraph → **stds get only (0.25) for the answer.**
- **Deduct 0.25 for language errors for every answer.**

Q	Answer Key	Score
Not es		
A-1	1. Identify the genetic disorder Lizzie Velasquez suffers from, and then mention two medical consequences she suffered from due to this condition. (Score: 01) Lizzie suffered from <u>lipodystrophy syndrome</u>. This condition made her <u>extremely thin</u>. It also <u>affected her vision</u>, so she lost sight in one eye and wasn't able to see clearly. (Deduct 0.25 for language errors in all questions)	01
A-2	2. How was school an emotionally exhausting environment for Lizzie? (Score: 01) At school, lizzie faced cruelty. Students there would constantly stare at her strange look in the school hallways. She would hear <u>merciless comments</u> about her <u>physical appearance</u> and how doesn't fit in. All this bullying made her emotionally exhausted. <i>(0.5 for each underlined idea)</i>	01
A-3	3. Based on paragraphs 5 to 8, explain how social media played both a positive and a negative role in shaping Lizzie Velasquez's personal journey. (Score: 1.5) During Lizzie's teenage years, social media played a very destructive role in her life after she saw a video posted online describing her as the ugliest woman in the world. This experience was very shocking. However, later on in life, Lizzie appeared on TED talk and delivered a speech that spread quickly on social media sending her message to millions of audiences asking them not to judge people based on outer appearance but rather on character. This was a very satisfying turning point in her life. <i>Stds can also mention the example of Dr. Oz show.</i> <i>(0.75 for each role)</i>	01
A-4	4. The writer asks, "What defines a person's value: outward appearance or inner strength?" Elaborate how Lizzie Velasquez's life answers this question. Provide examples from the text.. (Score: 1.5)? First, Lizzie answered this question by <u>not isolating herself from the society</u> and <u>not giving up</u> (or <u>by being resilient and self-determined</u>) when she faced harsh experiences as a student in school and as a teenager She also <u>pursued her education at university</u> and continued to <u>deliver her voice through public speeches</u> and T.V. shows to prove to people that what matters are our strong personalities and actions not outer	01

	images. Lizzie is <u>now a famous activist and figure</u> that works to help people judge others based on character and not on appearances. (0.5 for every underlined idea)	
B-1	1. <i>Identify two purposes the introduction serves. Explain the functions of these two purposes. (Score: 1.5)</i> First, the introduction highlights the purpose of the text which is how some people are misjudged based on outer looks and appearances. Second, it grabs readers' attention with questions about what makes a person of great value, the inner or outer shape. These questions motivate the reader to continue reading in order to know how Lizzie's life has answered such inquiries. Finally, it helps the writer set the scene for narrating the story of Lizzie's sufferings and how she was able to overcome them with determination. (Two purposes are required; 0.75 for purpose and justification)	1.5
B-2	2. <i>What is the thematic relationship between paragraphs 5 and 6? Justify your answer. (Score : 01)</i> The thematic relation between paragraphs 5 and 6 is that of problem-solution. Paragraph 5 raises the main conflict that faced Lizzie in her teenage life and how this traumatic experience might have led to her death. Paragraph 6 discusses the solution by showing how Lizzie chose to fight back and not to surrender and to become the heard voice that defends others against bullying and discrimination. (0.5 for identifying the thematic relation; 1 for justification)	1.5
B-3	3. <i>The above text is a biographical narrative. Explain why, and then state the writer's purpose. (Score: 1)</i> This text is a biographical narrative since it <u>tells the story of a real person</u> (Lizzie Velasquez). Also, the text narrates real events that happened with her and discusses the main challenges she faced. The writer wants to <u>teach the audience a very important lesson which is to truly judge people based on their behavior and character and not on their outer looks</u>. OR His purpose is <u>to narrate the story of a real person in order to teach us a lesson</u> which is ----- . (0.5 for identifying the reason, and 0.5 for the purpose)	1
C	What can you conclude about teenagers' health based on the bar graph? Support your answers with evidence. First, teenagers today face many common health issues (0.25). Based on the graph, anxiety and stress are the most widespread problem, affecting about 30% of teenagers. The second most common issue is overweight, which affects around 22% of teenagers showing that many struggle with unhealthy lifestyles or poor eating habits. Vision problems come next at about 15%, which may be linked to excessive screen time and limited eye care. Finally, eating disorders are the least common among these health issues, affecting only 12% of teenagers (1). Overall, the graph suggests that both mental health and physical health problems are significant issues	1.5

	for teenagers but mental health remains a major concern among young people (0.25).	
D	1. The experience (Paragraph 5): discovering the video posted online 2. They (Paragraph 8) audiences (0.25 each)	1
E	1. advocate-retained-shattering-resilience (0.25 each)	1